WEEK 8 · LECTURE L2 · UNIT III

Employee Lifecycle Engagement

Socialization at entry, why people leave and why they stay, and wellbeing as an output of how work is designed.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain socialization tactics and the outcomes of newcomer adjustment.
- Apply the unfolding model of turnover and job embeddedness.
- Distinguish hedonic and eudaimonic wellbeing and explain the vitamin model.
- Evaluate the mutual gains and conflicting outcomes views of wellbeing and performance.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 5 (create engagement programs across the employee lifecycle).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A team has the highest burnout in the firm and the lowest voluntary turnover. Why do people stay while burning out?

Write one theory name. We will test it against rivals.

THEORY IN DEPTH · JONES (1986); BAUER ET AL. (2007)

Entry: socialization and adjustment

THE CORE IDEA

How a firm socializes newcomers shapes how well they adjust and how they approach their role.

HOW IT WORKS

Adjustment, meaning role clarity, self efficacy and social acceptance, carries socialization into satisfaction, commitment, performance and retention.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Much evidence is cross sectional, and tactics overlap in practice.

IN PRACTICE

A bank pairs each new officer with a buddy and a fixed learning schedule; role clarity rises in the first quarter.

EXAM LENS

Use the three adjustment indicators to evaluate any onboarding design. Each depends heavily on the manager.

The unfolding model: most exits begin with a shock

Path	Shock?	Process
1	Yes	The shock triggers a script already in mind; the person leaves without weighing alternatives
2	Yes	The shock clashes with values or self image; the person leaves, often without another job
3	Yes	The shock prompts a search; the person leaves for a better alternative
4	No	Satisfaction erodes gradually; the person leaves, with or without searching

EXAM LENS

An annual survey can see only path 4. Paths 1 to 3 begin at a moment a manager could notice.

THEORY IN DEPTH · MITCHELL ET AL. (2001)

Why people stay: job embeddedness

THE CORE IDEA

People stay because of links to others, fit with job and place, and what they would sacrifice by leaving.

HOW IT WORKS

Embeddedness predicted intent to leave and voluntary turnover beyond satisfaction, commitment and job alternatives.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Embedded people can stay without being engaged; retention is not the same as motivation.

IN PRACTICE

Sales staff on strong commissions with deep local ties stay even when exhausted.

EXAM LENS

Use it to explain why low turnover can hide burnout. Pair with Job Demands Resources.

Two traditions, and a vitamin model

HEDONIC · RYAN AND DECI (2001)

Pleasure, satisfaction and the absence of distress: feeling good.

EUDAIMONIC · RYAN AND DECI (2001)

Meaning, growth and realizing potential: functioning well.

VITAMINS · WARR (1987)

Some job features help up to a point, then harm in excess. More is not always better.

THEORY IN DEPTH · GUEST (2017); VAN DE VOORDE ET AL. (2012)

Mutual gains or conflicting outcomes?

THE CORE IDEA

Guest argues HRM should put wellbeing and a positive employment relationship first, as a path to mutual gains.

HOW IT WORKS

Van De Voorde et al. found happiness and relationship wellbeing fit mutual gains, but health wellbeing fit conflicting outcomes.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Most studies are cross sectional; rival models are rarely tested against each other.

IN PRACTICE

A stretch target system may raise output and satisfaction with pay while health deteriorates.

EXAM LENS

Strong answers separate the three dimensions of wellbeing instead of treating it as one score.

HOW DEPLETION HAPPENS

Conservation of resources and recovery

HOBFOLL (1989)

People strive to protect resources. Loss weighs more than gain, and losses can spiral.

SONNENTAG AND FRITZ (2007)

Recovery comes from detachment, relaxation, mastery and control over leisure time.

KEY POINT

Strain becomes burnout when recovery fails. Always on feedback apps block detachment.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Why do burned out employees stay?

Theory	Explanation	Evidence that would favor it
Job Demands Resources	They stay but disengage; exit lags exhaustion	Rising cynicism before exits
Psychological contract	A transactional deal: pay for strain	Stayers describe the job as an exchange
Job embeddedness	Sacrifice and local ties outweigh strain	Stayers would lose commissions or community

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Low turnover shows employees are engaged." Critically evaluate using job embeddedness and the unfolding model. **20 marks**

A strong answer: explains both theories; separates staying from engagement; uses Job Demands Resources; proposes better measures.

Can HR practices raise both performance and wellbeing? Discuss the mutual gains debate. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Guest and Van De Voorde et al.; separates three dimensions of wellbeing; adds conservation of resources; reaches a view.

What are the three indicators of newcomer adjustment? **10 marks**

A strong answer: role clarity, self efficacy, social acceptance; cites Bauer et al.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Most exits start with a shock, not slow decline
2. People can stay without being engaged
3. Performance gains can come at the expense of health

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Costanza, D. P., Badger, J. M., Fraser, R. L., Severt, J. B., & Gade, P. A. (2012). Generational differences in work related attitudes: A meta analysis. *Journal of Business and Psychology, 27*(4), 375–394.

McKinsey & Company. (2022, July). The Great Attrition is making hiring harder. Are you searching the right talent pools? *McKinsey Quarterly*.

People Matters: selected articles on the employee lifecycle, as listed in the Lesson Plan.

Singh, S. K., & Singh, A. P. (2019). Interplay of organizational justice, psychological empowerment, organizational citizenship behavior, and job satisfaction in the context of circular economy. *Management Decision, 57*(4), 937–952.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 8 set readings. McKinsey (2022) and the lifecycle articles are the core readings for this lecture. Note: the Lesson Plan lists Singh and Singh (2019) under the Journal of Indian Business Research; the verified published record is shown here.

THEORY SOURCES · FOR REFERENCE

Sources for this lecture (1 of 4)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Bauer, T. N., Bodner, T., Erdogan, B., Truxillo, D. M., & Tucker, J. S. (2007). Newcomer adjustment during organizational socialization: A meta analytic review of antecedents, outcomes, and methods. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 92*(3), 707–721. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.92.3.707

Guest, D. E. (2017). Human resource management and employee well being: Towards a new analytic framework. *Human Resource Management Journal, 27*(1), 22–38. https://doi.org/10.1111/1748-8583.12139

Hobfoll, S. E. (1989). Conservation of resources: A new attempt at conceptualizing stress. *American Psychologist, 44*(3), 513–524. https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066x.44.3.513

Sources for this lecture (2 of 4)

Jones, G. R. (1986). Socialization tactics, self efficacy, and newcomers' adjustments to organizations. *Academy of Management Journal, 29*(2), 262–279. https://doi.org/10.2307/256188

Lee, T. W., & Mitchell, T. R. (1994). An alternative approach: The unfolding model of voluntary employee turnover. *Academy of Management Review, 19*(1). https://doi.org/10.2307/258835

Mitchell, T. R., Holtom, B. C., Lee, T. W., Sablynski, C. J., & Erez, M. (2001). Why people stay: Using job embeddedness to predict voluntary turnover. *Academy of Management Journal, 44*(6), 1102–1121. https://doi.org/10.2307/3069391

Sources for this lecture (3 of 4)

Ryan, R. M., & Deci, E. L. (2001). On happiness and human potentials: A review of research on hedonic and eudaimonic well being. *Annual Review of Psychology, 52*(1), 141–166. https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.psych.52.1.141

Sonnentag, S., & Fritz, C. (2007). The Recovery Experience Questionnaire: Development and validation of a measure for assessing recuperation and unwinding from work. *Journal of Occupational Health Psychology, 12*(3), 204–221. https://doi.org/10.1037/1076-8998.12.3.204

Sources for this lecture (4 of 4)

Van De Voorde, K., Paauwe, J., & Van Veldhoven, M. (2012). Employee well being and the HRM–organizational performance relationship: A review of quantitative studies. *International Journal of Management Reviews, 14*(4), 391–407. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1468-2370.2011.00322.x

Warr, P. (1987). *Work, unemployment, and mental health*. Oxford University Press.